

Lung Cancer Screening with Low Dose Computed Tomography (LDCT)

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Tracking Information

Publication Number

100-3

Manual Section Number

210.14

Manual Section Title

Lung Cancer Screening with Low Dose Computed Tomography (LDCT)

Version Number

2

Effective Date of this Version

02/10/2022

Implementation Date

10/03/2022

Description Information

Benefit Category

Additional Preventive Services

Please Note: This may not be an exhaustive list of all applicable Medicare benefit categories for this item or service.

Item/Service Description

A. General

Lung cancer is the third most common cancer and the leading cause of cancer deaths in the United States. Cancer of the lung and bronchus accounted for over 130,000 deaths in 2021 (more than the total number of estimated deaths from colon, breast and prostate cancer combined) with a median age at death of 72 years. Computed tomography (CT) is an imaging procedure that uses specialized x-ray equipment to create detailed pictures of areas inside the body. Low dose computed tomography (LDCT) is a chest CT scan performed at settings to minimize radiation exposure compared to a standard chest CT. Under §1861(ddd) of the Social Security Act (the Act), the Centers for Medicare & Medicaid Services(CMS) has

the authority to add coverage of “additional preventive services” through the Medicare national coverage determination (NCD) process if certain statutory requirements are met: (1) reasonable and necessary for the prevention or early detection of illness or disability, (2) recommended with a grade of A or B by the United States Preventive Services Task Force (USPSTF), and (3) appropriate for individuals entitled to benefits under Part A or enrolled under Part B.

Indications and Limitations of Coverage

B. Nationally Covered Indications

Effective for claims with dates of service on or after February 10, 2022, CMS has determined that the evidence is sufficient to cover, under Medicare Part B, a lung cancer screening counseling and shared decision-making visit, and for appropriate beneficiaries, annual screening for lung cancer with LDCT, as an additional preventive service benefit under the Medicare program, only if all of the following eligibility criteria are met.

Beneficiary Eligibility Criteria

Beneficiaries must meet all of the following eligibility criteria:

- Age 50 - 77 years;
- Asymptomatic (no signs or symptoms of lung cancer);
- Tobacco smoking history of at least 20 pack-years (one pack-year = smoking one pack per day for one year; 1 pack = 20 cigarettes);
- Current smoker or one who has quit smoking within the last 15 years; and,
- Receive an order for lung cancer screening with LDCT.

Counseling and Shared Decision-Making Visit

Before the beneficiary's first lung cancer LDCT screening, the beneficiary must receive a counseling and shared decision-making visit that meets all of the following criteria, and is appropriately documented in the beneficiary's medical records:

- Determination of beneficiary eligibility;
- Shared decision-making, including the use of one or more decision aids;
- Counseling on the importance of adherence to annual lung cancer LDCT screening, impact of comorbidities and ability or willingness to undergo diagnosis and treatment; and,
- Counseling on the importance of maintaining cigarette smoking abstinence if former smoker; or the importance of smoking cessation if current smoker and, if appropriate, furnishing of information about tobacco cessation interventions.

Reading Radiologist Eligibility Criteria

The reading radiologist must have board certification or board eligibility with the American Board of Radiology or equivalent organization.

Radiology Imaging Facility Eligibility Criteria

Lung cancer screening with LDCT must be furnished in a radiology imaging facility that utilizes a standardized lung nodule identification, classification, and reporting system.

C. Nationally Non-Covered Indications

Preventive services are non-covered by Medicare unless specifically covered in this NCD, any other NCD, or in statute or regulations.

D. Other

Medicare Part B coinsurance and deductible are waived for this preventive service.

(This NCD last reviewed February 2022.)

Claims Processing Instructions

[TN 11388 \(Medicare Claims Processing\)](#) 

Transmittal Information

Transmittal Number

11388

Coverage Transmittal Link

<https://www.cms.gov/files/document/r11388ncd.pdf> 

Revision History

06/2022 - Transmittal 10832, dated June 2, 2021, is being rescinded and replaced by Transmittal 11453, dated, June 10, 2022, to revise NCD 90.2, NGS, revises business requirement 12124.2 and 12124.2.1 and its associated spreadsheet of coding by retaining all ICD-10 NOC diagnosis codes proposed for deletion effective July 1, 2022. ([TN 11453](#) ) (CR12124)

04/2022 - The purpose of this change request is to inform interested parties that effective February 10, 2022, CMS is expanding beneficiary eligibility for screening for lung cancer with LDCT. ([TN 11388](#) ) (CR12691)

09/2021 - This Change Request (CR) constitutes a maintenance update of ICD-10 conversions and other coding updates specific to NCDs. These NCD coding changes are the result of newly available codes, coding revisions to NCDs released separately, or coding feedback received. ([TN 11025](#) ) (CR12399)

08/2021 - This Change Request (CR) constitutes a maintenance update of ICD-10 conversions and other coding updates specific to NCDs. These NCD coding changes are the result of newly available codes, coding revisions to NCDs released separately, or coding feedback received. ([TN 10963](#) ) (CR12399)

06/2021 - This Change Request (CR) constitutes a maintenance update of ICD-10 conversions and other coding updates specific to NCDs. These NCD coding changes are the

result of newly available codes, coding revisions to NCDs released separately, or coding feedback received. ([TN 10832](#)) (CR12124)

05/2021 - This Change Request (CR) constitutes a maintenance update of ICD-10 conversions and other coding updates specific to NCDs. These NCD coding changes are the result of newly available codes, coding revisions to NCDs released separately, or coding feedback received. ([TN 10804](#)) (CR12124)

03/2021 - This Change Request (CR) constitutes a maintenance update of ICD-10 conversions and other coding updates specific to NCDs. These NCD coding changes are the result of newly available codes, coding revisions to NCDs released separately, or coding feedback received. ([TN 10624](#)) (CR12124)

04/2016 - Transmittal 1630, dated February 26, 2016, is being rescinded and replaced by Transmittal 1658 to (1) remove duplicate spreadsheet NCD210.3, (2) add missing spreadsheet NCD20.33, (3) add B/MAC to requirement 3 at request of WPS/B, (4) rename the spreadsheet titles, and, (5) provide a link to the attached spreadsheets for more efficient ease of reference and accessibility. All other information remains the same. ([TN 1658](#)) (CR9540)

08/2015 - The purpose of this Change Request (CR) is to inform contractors that Medicare covers lung cancer screening with low dose computed tomography (LDCT) if all eligibility requirements listed in the National Coverage Determination(NCD) are met. Effective date 02/05/2015. Implementation date: 01/04/2016. ([TN 185](#)) (CR9246)

National Coverage Analyses (NCAs)

This NCD has been or is currently being reviewed under the National Coverage Determination process. The following are existing associations with NCAs, from the National Coverage Analyses database.

- [Original Consideration for Screening for Lung Cancer with Low Dose Computed Tomography \(LDCT\) \(CAG-00439N\)](#)
- [First reconsideration for Screening for Lung Cancer with Low Dose Computed Tomography \(LDCT\) \(CAG-00439R\)](#)

Additional Information

Other Versions

Title	Version	Effective Between	
Lung Cancer Screening with Low Dose Computed Tomography (LDCT)	2	02/10/2022 - N/A	You are here
Lung Cancer Screening with Low Dose Computed Tomography (LDCT)	1	02/05/2015 - 02/10/2022	View